

- A destination group, identified by a destination Group ID in the message, authenticated by an Operational Group Key from the Group Key Management Cluster, during the operational phase.

6.6.2.1.1. PASE and Group Subjects

Note that the subject is not considered to be an individual Node when the authentication is via pass-code or group symmetric key; in these cases, the administrative root of trust is conditional only upon bearing the correct passcode during session establishment, or bearing the Operational Group Key when constructing a group message.

6.6.2.1.2. Subjects identified by CASE Authenticated Tag

In contrast, a CASE Authenticated Tag (CAT) is a [special subject distinguished name](#) within the Operational Certificate shared during CASE session establishment that functions as a group-like tag. Such a tag can be applied to several Nodes, thereby facilitating management of Access Control Entries that use the same set of Nodes as subjects. Because these tags are authenticated within the CASE session context, the administrative root of trust does chain back through the individual source Node to the Fabric’s [trusted root](#). This makes CATs suitable for group-like use while maintaining secure authentication and attribution ability.

Each CAT is 32-bit and equally divided into identifier value and its corresponding version:

- The upper 16-bits are allocated to identifier value
- The lower 16-bits are allocated to the version number

The identifier value uniquely identifies a CAT.

The CAT identifier value space is allocated as described in the [Table 92, “CAT Identifier Value Allocations”](#). This table reserves space for the use of CAT identifiers that SHOULD NOT be used for any other purposes other than specified. [Table 92, “CAT Identifier Value Allocations”](#) lists the allocation rules of CAT identifiers that SHALL be used for the [Joint Fabric](#).

Table 92. CAT Identifier Value Allocations

Range	Type
0xFFFF	Administrator identifier
0xFFFE	Anchor identifier
0xF000 to 0xFFFFD	Reserved for future use
0x0000 to 0xEFFF	Generally available

The [CAT Identifier Space](#) reserves the following identifiers for special use within the context of the [Joint Fabric](#) and SHALL NOT apply to fabrics other than the [Joint Fabric](#).

- 0xFFFF SHALL represent the [Administrator CAT](#) identifier. The Administrator CAT SHALL be used to grant [Administer](#) privilege to a group of Administrator Nodes participating in the context of the [Joint Fabric](#). See [Section 12.2.4.1, “Administrator CAT”](#) for more details. The version number of the Administrator CAT SHALL be initially set to 0x0001.
- 0xFFFE SHALL represent the [Anchor CAT](#) identifier. The Anchor CAT SHALL be used to validate